Primary Survey

Secondary Survey

- Consider etiology of symptoms
- Evaluate for dehydration, signs of shock

If signs of Shock or Dehydration

Normal Saline or Lactated Ringers
Adult: 250 – 500ml IV
Pediatric: 5-10ml/kg IV

EMT

Nausea & Vomiting

Consider Metoclopramide
Adults Only: 10mg IV/IM

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Patient Care Goals

1. Identify life-threatening causes associated with nausea and vomiting
2. Improve patient comfort

Patient Inclusion & Exclusion Criteria

Inclusion Criteria

- Patients presenting with nausea and/or vomiting. Including traumatic and non-traumatic causes.

Exclusion Criteria

- None noted.

Key Patient Assessment Points

1. **Secondary Survey**
   - Perform a focused physical examination to identify potential causes of nausea and vomiting,
2. **Patient history**
   - Use OPQRST and SAMPLE history to identify potentially serious underlying causes.
3. **Determine Triage Category**
   - Determine Triage Category as per Patient Triage Categories CPG.

Patient Management & Interventions

1. **Primary and Secondary Survey**
   - Perform primary and secondary survey as per Universal Care CPG.
2. **Consider Red Flags**
   - Persistent vomiting or hematemesis
   - Suspected pregnancy complications (e.g., ectopic pregnancy, miscarriage)
3. **Evaluate for Signs of Shock or Instability**
   - Hypotension (SBP <90 mmHg in adults, or age-specific for pediatrics)
   - Tachycardia (HR >100 in adults, or age-specific for pediatrics)
   - Altered mental status
   - Poor perfusion (cool, clammy skin, delayed capillary refill)
4. **Consider ALS back-up**
   - Consider the requirement for ALS back-up as per Universal Care CPG.
   - It is generally not appropriate to request ALS back-up for the administration of antiemetics.
5. **Establish IV Access**
   - Indicated for dehydration, hypotension, or anticipated medication administration
6. **Fluid Resuscitation**
   - Indications:
     - Signs of Shock or dehydration.
   - Administer Normal Saline or Ringers Lactate:
     - Adults: 500-1000 mL bolus, reassess, repeat as needed
     - Pediatrics: 20 mL/kg bolus, reassess, repeat as needed
7. **Assess and Manage Pain**
   - Assess and manage pain as per Pain Management CPG.
8. **Medication Administration**
   - For Nausea/Vomiting:
     - Administer Metoclopramide:
       - Adults: 10 mg IV/IM
       - Pediatrics: Not recommended for pediatrics

Patient Safety Considerations

- Nausea and Vomiting typically has an underlying cause.

Clinical Insights & Additional Guidance

- Prophylactic administration of anti-nausea medications for opiates (e.g. morphine) is not recommended.

Documentation

- Identification: Full patient name, age, and gender.
- Mechanism / Medical Complaint: Abdominal pain / traumatic injury – include duration, severity, factors.
- Injuries / Information: Relevant history – recent food intake, medications, associated symptoms (e.g., fever, diarrhea, hematemesis).
- Signs: Vital signs, abdominal exam findings (tenderness, guarding, rebound), head injury findings (if relevant), mental status.
- Treatment: Medications given (e.g., metoclopramide), IV fluids, pain scale before and after intervention.
- Allergies: Particularly medication-related (e.g., antiemetics or analgesics).
- Medications: Current prescribed or OTC medications.
- Background: History of GI disease, renal issues, diabetes, prior surgeries.
- Other: ECG findings if performed, pregnancy status if applicable, transport rationale.

Key Performance Indicators

1. Administer an antiemetic to all patients with moderate to severe nausea or vomiting (unless contraindicated or inappropriate).

References

1. National Association of State EMS Officials (NASEMSO) (2022) *National Model EMS Clinical Guidelines*.
2. Joint Royal Colleges Ambulance Liaison Committee (JRCALC) (2025) *Nausea and Vomiting guideline*. JRCALC Plus and iCPG apps.
3. BC Emergency Health Services (BCEHS) (2025) *Clinical Practice Guidelines: E06 Nausea and Vomiting*. BCEHS Handbook.
4. St John New Zealand (2025) *Clinical Procedures and Guidelines - Comprehensive edition*.
5. Queensland Ambulance Service (QAS) (2025) *Clinical Practice Guidelines: Medical/Nausea and vomiting*.